

I found my first diamond, if not quite in Philadelphia, nearby. Through the extraordinary preparation for college that Blair Academy had given me, I gained admission to Princeton University. To make it financially possible for me to attend, the university offered me both a full scholarship and a job waiting on tables in Commons. (A waiter yet again—I must have been good at it!) In later years, I worked at the Athletic Association ticket office, managing one of its departments during my junior and senior years.

With a series of summer jobs (one as a runner in a local brokerage firm; another as a reporter on the police beat for the *Philadelphia Evening Bulletin*), I was able to earn the remaining money I needed. I worked very hard, and the hours were long. But I loved hard work then—I still do—and I grew up with the priceless advantage of having to work for what I got. But in my long career I don't ever recall thinking of work as work, with one exception: a stint as a pinsetter in a bowling alley (now there's a truly Sysiphean job!).

At Princeton, a Discovery

While I was studying at Princeton, my parents' marriage fell apart. My father moved to New York, and my beloved mother, terminally ill, remained in Philadelphia. I wanted to return there to be with her after my graduation in 1951, and fate intervened to make it possible. (Sadly, her life ended in 1952.)

At Princeton, this callow, idealistic young kid with a crew cut had determined to write his economics department senior thesis on a subject on which no earlier thesis had been written. Not John Maynard Keynes, not Adam Smith, not Karl Marx, but a subject fresh and new. What but fate can account for the fact that in December 1949, searching for my topic, I opened *Fortune* magazine to page 116 and read an article ("Big Money in Boston") about a financial instrument that I had never heard of before: the mutual fund. When the article described the industry as "tiny but contentious," I knew that I had found my topic and, though I couldn't know it at the time, another diamond as well.